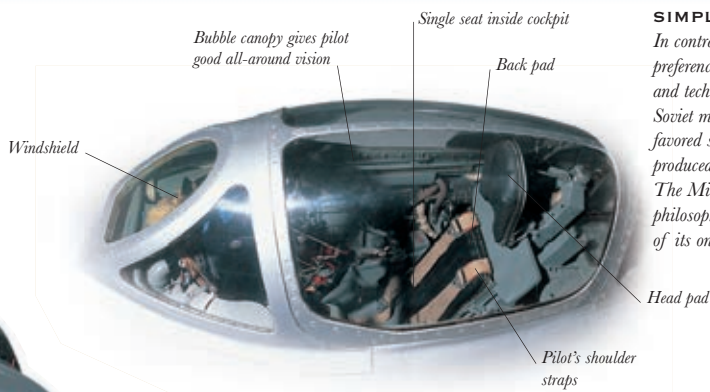




TEST FLIGHT

A US Air Force crew is here giving a Russian-built MiG-15 its final examination before a test flight (which took place in Okinawa, 1953). The aircraft fell into U.S. hands thanks to a defecting North Korean pilot.



SIMPLE DESIGN

In contrast to the US's preference for elite fighters and technological complexity, Soviet military planners favored simple machines produced in large numbers. The MiG-15 reflected this philosophy in the simplicity of its onboard equipment.



POWERFUL ENGINE

The MiG-15 is powered by a fuselage-mounted Klimov VK/1FA turbojet engine, which is a version of the Rolls-Royce Nene (developed in Britain in the mid-1940s).



TOP PERFORMER

When US pilots fighting in the Korean war first sighted the MiG-15, they were impressed. Its clean lines, 35-degree swept-wing, and single engine mounted in the fuselage all helped ensure outstanding performance.

POPULAR FIGHTER

The MiG-15 (a trainer is shown here) was the first Soviet swept-wing fighter to be mass produced. Many thousands of the MiG-15 were manufactured – not just in Russia, but in Poland and Czechoslovakia as well.



Main undercarriage